Xiaolin Zhou

Department of Resource Economics
University of Massachusetts Amherst
80 Campus Center Way, Amherst, MA 01003

Phone: (520) 232-4458
Email: xiaolinzhou@umass.edu
Website: https://xiaolinzhou1997.github.io/

FIELDS

Energy and Environmental Economics, Industrial Organization, Applied Economics

EDUCATION

University of Massachusetts Amherst

PhD, Resource Economics — 2027 (expected)

University of Arizona

MS, Agricultural and Resource Economics — 2021

Tamkang University

BA, Industrial Economics — 2019

BBA, Finance — 2019

RESEARCH

Job Market Paper

Subsidies, Cost Trends, and Pass-Through: Evidence from the Residential Solar Market. Most updated version.

> Solar subsidies are scheduled to fall as deployment grows, while installation costs change over the same period, so pass-through estimates that rely on subsidy timing can pick up cost trends. I study two Massachusetts programs that pay homeowners per kilowatt-hour, first through tradable certificates and then through a fixed rate. I identify pass-through from differences in the subsidy across roofs that the same installer equips in the same month, which arise because the payment depends on each roof's generation. I find that buyers receive about 85 percent of the subsidy under both designs, whereas a comparison over time suggests a 26-point gap. Installers raise prices only slightly for roofs that earn larger subsidies, which, with log-concave demand, bounds their markups at 2–7 percent of price.

Working Papers

Market Power in the New England Electricity Market: Evidence from Nuclear Refueling Outages. With Ming Ge, James Ji, and Matt Woerman.

> Uses ISO New England day-ahead data, 2016–2018. Outages raise prices $4.9/MWh; 36% of the rise is market power, a $43–45 million annual transfer from consumers.

Can Driver-Assistance Technology Offset the Vehicle-Weight Externality? With Yongjoon Park.

> Links 785,000 Massachusetts crash records to vehicle weight and safety features by VIN. Colliding with a vehicle 1,000 lb heavier raises severe-injury risk 13%; driver-assistance features are associated with a smaller effect.

TEACHING

University of Massachusetts Amherst

Instructor of Record *(Undergraduate)*

Managerial Economics — Summer 2024, 2025, 2026

Hunger in the Global Economy — Fall 2025

TA, Intro to Statistics, Industrial Organization, Public Policy in Private Market, Hunger in the Global Economy *(Undergraduate)*

TA, Statistical Inference *(Graduate)*

EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, *Prof. Emily Wang, UMass Amherst* — 2023

Research Assistant, *Prof. Matt Woerman, UMass Amherst* — 2022

Research Assistant, *Prof. George Frisvold, University of Arizona* — 2019–2021

Compliance Analyst Intern, *Haitong Securities* 2018

PRESENTATION AERE Summer Conference, UMass Amherst Environmental Economics Reading Group, UMass Amherst IO Reading Group, UC Berkeley Summer School in Environmental and Energy Economics

AWARDS **Department Travel Grant** (×3), *Resource Economics, UMass Amherst*

CALS Fellowship, *College of Agriculture and Life Sciences, University of Arizona* 2019

SKILLS **Computing**: R, Python, Git, LaTeX

Language: English, Chinese (Native)

SERVICE **Graduate Student Representative**, *Department Hiring Committee* 2026

Organizer, *Graduate Research Support Group* 2023

REFERENCES **Christine Crago**, *Associate Professor of Resource Economics, UMass Amherst*
ccrago@resecon.umass.edu

Yongjoon Park, *Assistant Professor of Resource Economics, UMass Amherst*
yongjoonpark@umass.edu

Matt Woerman, *Assistant Professor, Colorado State University*
matt.woerman@colostate.edu